Publishing and Sharing in Tableau

Assignment — Completed Answers

1. What is the key difference between publishing a dashboard on Tableau Public versus Tableau Server/Cloud in terms of accessibility and data security?

• Tableau Public: The dashboard and its underlying data are published to a free, fully open platform. Anyone on the internet can view, search for, and download the workbook and the data behind it. There is no login requirement and no way to restrict access, so it is not suitable for sensitive or confidential data.

• Tableau Server/Cloud: The dashboard is hosted on a private, organization-controlled environment. Access is restricted through user authentication, permissions, and site/project-level security. Only authorized users (based on roles and groups) can view or interact with the dashboard, and data can remain secure behind a firewall or in a governed cloud environment.

2. When publishing a Tableau dashboard, what happens to a live connection compared to an extract? How does this affect data refresh and performance?

• Live Connection: The dashboard queries the original data source directly, in real time, every time it is opened or refreshed. This means users always see the most current data, but performance depends on the speed of the underlying database and network, and heavy queries can slow down the dashboard, especially with many concurrent users.

• Extract: A static, compressed snapshot of the data (a .hyper file) is saved and published along with the dashboard. This snapshot must be refreshed on a schedule (or manually) to stay current. Extracts generally load and render much faster because Tableau's optimized engine handles the queries, but the data can be out of date until the next scheduled refresh.

3. In Tableau Server or Cloud (conceptually), which feature allows administrators to control which users can view, interact with, or edit a published dashboard?

Permissions (Access Control), managed through Users, Groups, Sites, and Projects. Administrators assign roles/permission rules (such as Viewer, Explorer, Creator) at the project, workbook, or individual content level, which determine whether a user can view, interact with, filter, download, or edit a given dashboard.

4. If you want users to view a dashboard but not download the underlying data, which permission setting would you adjust in Tableau Server?

You would disable/deny the "Download Data" (and typically "Download Full Data" / "Export Data") permission capability for that user or group, while keeping the "View" capability enabled. This lets them see and interact with the dashboard without being able to export the raw data behind it.

5. Name two methods by which a Tableau dashboard can be embedded into a web page or website.

• Using the built-in "Embed Code" option in Tableau Server/Cloud/Public, which generates an or JavaScript snippet that can be pasted directly into an HTML page.

• Using the Tableau Embedding API (Tableau JavaScript API), which allows developers to programmatically embed and customize dashboard views within a web application, controlling filters, size, and interactivity via code.

6. List two best practices you should follow when preparing a dashboard for public sharing to ensure data security and privacy.

• Remove or mask any personally identifiable information (PII), confidential figures, or sensitive fields before publishing, and use an extract (not a live connection) so the source database is never directly exposed.

• Review and restrict permissions/filters (e.g., use user filters or data source filters) so that only intended, non-sensitive data is visible, and double-check that no hidden worksheets, tooltips, or underlying data views expose extra information.

7. After publishing a dashboard, users report a "Data not found" error. What is the most common cause related to data source settings?

The most common cause is that the dashboard uses a live connection (or an extract dependent on a live source) pointing to a data source that isn't accessible from the server — for example, the file path, database server, or network location is different/unreachable from the Tableau Server environment, or the required data source credentials were not embedded/saved during publishing.

8. When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a secure internal portal, what two additional security measures should be implemented to ensure only authorized users can access the embedded content?

• Implement Single Sign-On (SSO) or trusted authentication (trusted tickets), so the portal verifies the user's identity with Tableau Server/Cloud before displaying the embedded view, rather than relying on a public link.

• Enforce SSL/HTTPS encryption for all traffic between the portal and Tableau Server/Cloud, combined with IP restrictions or network-level access controls (e.g., VPN/firewall rules) so the embedded content is only reachable from approved internal networks.